- When a system of linear equation has one solution (the graphs of the equations intersect once), the system is said to be a consistent system.
- When a system of linear equation has no solution (the graphs of the equations don't intersect at all), the system is said to be an inconsistent system.
- When a system of linear equation has infinitely many solutions, the lines are the same (the graph of lines are identical at all points), the system is consistent.

Solving by Substitution Method

In this method we substitute the value of one variable, by expressing it in terms of the other variable to reduce the given equation of two variables into equation of one variable (in order to solve the pair of linear equations). Since we are substituting the value of one variable in terms of the other variable, this method is called substitution method.

The procedure may be put shortly as follows:

Step 1: From any of the given two equations, find the value of one variable in terms of the other.

Step 2: Substitute the value of the variable, obtained in step 1 in the other equation and solve it.

Step 3: Substitute the value of the variable obtained in step 2 in the result of step 1 and get the value of the remaining unknown variable.

Example 3.48 Solve the system of linear equations $x+3y=16$ and $2x-y=4$ by substitution method.

Solution

Given $x+3y=16$ ... (1)

$2x-y=4$ ... (2)

Step 1	Step 2	Step 3	Solution
From equation (2) $2x-y=4$ $-y=4-2x$ $y=2x-4$ ...(3)	Substitute (3) in (1) $x+3y=16$ $x+3(2x-4)=16$ $x+6x-12=16$ $7x=28$ $x=4$	Substitute $x=4$ in (3) $y=2x-4$ $y=2(4)-4$ $y=4$	$x=4$ and $y=4$

Example 3.49 The sum of the digits of a given two digit number is 5. If the digits are reversed, the new number is reduced by 27. Find the given number.

Solution

Let x be the digit at ten's place and y be the digit at unit place.

Given that $x+y=5$ ..... (1)

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